

Merlin G. Komenda

Implementation Leader | AI-Native Operations | Systems Design

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Director of Implementation who designs the operating systems behind customer outcomes. Known for process architecture, AI-enabled workflows, and cross-functional rebuilds that fully scale. Track record of rebuilding implementation from the ground up, cutting time-to-value by 50%, eliminating 35% of operational effort, and increasing team capacity without increased headcount.

Selected Leadership Impact

- Reduced implementation time-to-live by 38% and time to first value by 50%.
- Eliminated 35% of operational effort through cross-functional process redesign.
- Led onboarding across a \$5M ARR portfolio.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Director of Implementation (global) – Zappi

09/2024 - present

- Redesigned the global implementation operating model across a \$5M ARR portfolio, cutting time-to-live by 38% and time to first value by 50% while maintaining 9/10 customer satisfaction.
- Rebuilt implementation infrastructure from scratch: tiered frameworks by customer type, playbooks, handoff processes, and ownership matrices, making implementation outcomes predictable and repeatable at scale.
- Rebuilt cross-functional operating rhythm across Sales, CS, and AM, establishing clear ownership, shared timelines, and escalation processes that didn't exist before.
- Scaled implementation capacity to match company growth without adding headcount, developing the team through AI-enabled workflows and process design while absorbing increasing portfolio demand.
- Built the framework for how the implementation team uses AI, including what automates best versus what accelerates from human expertise and judgment.
- Shifted roughly 30% of workflows to AI-assisted execution, increasing capacity by an estimated 40% without increasing headcount.

Customer Expertise Manager – Zappi

07/2023 - 08/2024

- Led onboarding strategy for enterprise and mid-market customers, improving NPS (34+) and CSAT (4.5).
- Led process optimization initiatives to improve delivery consistency.
- Partnered cross-functionally to launch new knowledge resources and digital assets.

Senior Project Manager, Operations - Bonterra

07/2022 - 06/2023

- Led cross-functional process redesign, eliminating 35% of operational effort.
- Served as SME for enterprise implementation lifecycle/execution, training others, and providing guidance during challenges.
- Harnessed platform data (product requests, bugs, usage, etc.), and rebuilt communication channels between the Customer Success, Project Managers, Sales, and Engineering teams to remove information silos.

Project Manager- GiveGab/EveryAction/Bonterra

09/2021 - 07/2022

- Managed 25+ implementations annually across foundations, NPOs, and universities, supporting \$101M+ in fundraising revenue over three years
- Developed internal best practices and trained new team members during rapid team expansion.

Associate Project Manager - GiveGab

09/2018 - 09/2021

- Supported concurrent client implementations in a high-growth startup environment, delivering webinars and client training.

Customer Success Representative - GiveGab

11/2017 - 09/2018

- Managed 40-50 concurrent inbound support cases while exceeding response and satisfaction metrics.

Owner, Merlin's Property Care

08/2016 - 09/2018

- Founded and operated a landscaping business; led small crews and managed client proposals and budgets.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Art in Communications – SUNY Cortland

Graduated: 2017

PLATFORMS

Systems & Tools: Salesforce, Jira, Airtable, Tableau, Sisense

AI & Automation: Claude/Claude Code, ChatGPT/Codex, Gemini